

THE FIXER'S DESK

Getting the Calculator Ready to Test

From the GitHub invitation to the app running with Flask in VS Code

For Christopher - Product QA

Where this guide ends

The guide is complete when the calculator is open in a browser, the Welcome screen is visible, and the Flask terminal remains running in VS Code.

What you will need

- [] The GitHub invitation from Deidra
- [] Your GitHub account
- [] Visual Studio Code installed
- [] An internet connection for the first setup
- [] About 15 to 30 minutes for the first setup

Keep the terminal open while testing

The terminal window in VS Code is what keeps the app running. Closing it or stopping the command will close the local app.

Part 1 - Accept the repository invitation

1

Open the GitHub invitation

Open the invitation email or GitHub notification from Deidra.

2

Accept the invitation

Choose the button that says Accept invitation or View invitation, then confirm that you want to join the repository.

3

Open the repository

After accepting, GitHub should take you to the Food Truck Event Profit Calculator repository. Keep this page open.

What the repository is

The repository is the shared project folder stored on GitHub. You will make your own copy of it on your computer so you can run and test the app.

Part 2 - Copy the repository address

1. On the repository page, select the green Code button.
2. Make sure the Local tab is selected.
3. Make sure HTTPS is selected.
4. Select the copy button beside the repository address.

Do not download the ZIP file

Cloning the repository keeps your copy connected to GitHub and makes future updates much easier to receive.

Part 3 - Clone the project in VS Code

1

Open VS Code

You can close any unrelated folders or projects that are already open.

2

Start the clone command

On the VS Code Welcome screen, choose Clone Git Repository. If that option is not visible, press Ctrl+Shift+P, type Git: Clone, and choose Git: Clone.

3

Paste the repository address

Paste the address you copied from GitHub and press Enter.

4

Choose where the project will live

Choose a normal folder on your computer, such as Documents or C:\Projects. VS Code will create the project folder inside it.

5

Open the cloned project

When VS Code asks whether you want to open the cloned repository, choose Open.

Sign in if prompted

VS Code may open a browser and ask you to authorize GitHub. Sign in with your GitHub account, approve the request, and return to VS Code.

Confirm the project opened correctly

In the Explorer panel on the left side of VS Code, you should see project files and folders. Look for these items:

- [] README.md
- [] requirements.txt
- [] app.py
- [] templates
- [] static
- [] tests

If VS Code asks whether you trust the authors

Choose Yes, I trust the authors. This allows VS Code to use the project normally.

Confirm you are on the main branch

Look at the lower-left corner of VS Code. The branch name should say main. If it says something else, select the branch name and choose main.

If VS Code says Git is not installed

Git is the program VS Code uses to clone the repository. If VS Code reports that Git is missing:

5. Open a web browser and go to git-scm.com.
6. Download and install Git for Windows using the recommended options.
7. Close every VS Code window.
8. Reopen VS Code and repeat the cloning steps.

Stop here if the repository will not open

Take a screenshot of the message and send it to Deidra. Do not create a new empty project or download a different copy.

Open the VS Code terminal

9. At the top of VS Code, select Terminal.
10. Select New Terminal.
11. A terminal panel will open at the bottom of VS Code.

The line in the terminal should end with the project folder name, similar to:

```
PS C:\Projects\food-truck-event-profit-calculator>
```

About the commands in this guide

Click inside the terminal, copy one command at a time, paste it, and press Enter. Wait for each command to finish before using the next one.

Part 4 - Check for Python 3.12

Paste this command into the VS Code terminal and press Enter:

```
py -3.12 --version
```

The result you want

```
Python 3.12.x
```

The final number can be different. Any version beginning with Python 3.12 is correct.

If Python 3.12 is not found

12. Open a web browser and go to python.org/downloads/windows.
13. Download a Python 3.12 installer for Windows.
14. Run the installer. If the installer offers Add Python to PATH, select it.
15. Finish the installation.
16. Close VS Code completely and reopen the project.
17. Open a new terminal and run the version command again.

Use Python 3.12 for this project

Do not substitute another Python version unless Deidra specifically asks you to.

Part 5 - Create the project environment

The project environment keeps this app and its required software together. Run:

```
py -3.12 -m venv .venv
```

This command may finish without printing a message. That is normal.

Verify that it was created:

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe --version
```

You should again see Python 3.12.x.

If you see Access is denied

Close any other VS Code windows or Python programs, restart the computer, reopen this project, and try the environment command again.

Part 6 - Install the app requirements

First, update the installer inside the project environment:

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install --upgrade pip
```

Wait until the command finishes and the terminal returns to a new prompt.

Next, install everything the calculator needs:

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This is usually the longest step

The terminal will display many lines while it downloads and installs the project requirements. Let it finish. Do not close VS Code during this step.

How to know the installation finished

The terminal will return to a line ending with the project folder and a > symbol. The final lines should not contain a red error saying the installation failed.

If the installation fails

Do not keep repeating the command. Send Deidra:

- [] A screenshot showing the red error
- [] The last 20 to 30 lines in the terminal
- [] A note saying which command you were running

Do not change project files to fix setup problems

Setup errors should be reported before anything in the project is edited.

Optional visual check

In the Explorer panel, the project should now contain a folder named .venv. VS Code may hide it inside the file list until you scroll.

Part 7 - Start the calculator with Flask

Run this command in the VS Code terminal:

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe -m flask --app app.py run
```

Wait for the Flask address

After a moment, the terminal should show a local address similar to:

```
Running on http://127.0.0.1:5000
```

1

Open the address

Hold Ctrl and click the address in the terminal. If it does not open, copy the full address and paste it into a web browser.

2

Confirm the calculator opens

The Food Truck Event Profit Calculator should appear. On a new computer, the Welcome screen should normally be the first screen.

3

Leave Flask running

Return to VS Code if needed, but do not close the terminal. You can minimize VS Code while you test the calculator in the browser.

The app is running only on this computer

The 127.0.0.1 address is a private local address. It does not publish the calculator to the internet.

When you are finished testing for the day

18. Return to the VS Code terminal.
19. Click inside the terminal.
20. Press Ctrl+C once.
21. Wait for the normal PowerShell prompt to return.
22. Close VS Code and the browser when you are ready.

How to open the app next time

23. Open VS Code.
24. Choose File > Open Recent and select the calculator project.
25. Choose Terminal > New Terminal.
26. Run the Flask command again.
27. Open the local address shown in the terminal.

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe -m flask --app app.py run
```

Ready-to-test checklist

- ☐ The GitHub invitation has been accepted.
- ☐ The repository is cloned and open in VS Code.
- ☐ The branch shown in VS Code is main.
- ☐ Python 3.12 is installed.
- ☐ The .venv project environment was created.
- ☐ The requirements installed without an error.
- ☐ The Flask command is running in the VS Code terminal.
- ☐ The calculator is open in a browser.
- ☐ The Welcome screen or calculator interface is visible.

You are ready

Once every item above is complete, continue with Christopher's Product Testing Guide and Product Test Data.

Common problems

What happened	What to do
VS Code cannot clone the repository	Confirm the GitHub invitation was accepted. Sign into GitHub in the browser when VS Code asks.
Git is not installed	Install Git for Windows, close VS Code, reopen it, and clone again.
Python 3.12 is not found	Install Python 3.12, close VS Code, reopen it, and retry the version command.
The command says requirements.txt cannot be found	The terminal is not inside the project folder. Reopen the cloned project in VS Code and create a new terminal.
The Flask command keeps running	That is correct. Flask must keep running while the app is open.
The browser says it cannot connect	Check that the Flask terminal is still running. Use the exact address currently shown in the terminal.
The terminal shows a traceback or red error	Stop and send Deidra a screenshot plus the last lines of the terminal.

What to send Deidra when something goes wrong

- ☐ A screenshot that includes the full error message
- ☐ The exact step you were completing
- ☐ The command you ran, if the problem happened in the terminal
- ☐ Whether the app ever opened successfully before the problem

Protect the project copy

Do not delete project files, edit code, or use Clear All Data unless Deidra or the testing guide specifically tells you to.